

RAJESH DAMMALA

Staff Escalation Manager

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[Rajesh Dammala - Staff Escalation Manager](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Escalation Manager with 16+ years in support engineering, mission-critical incident response, service recovery, and operational improvement. Deep experience stabilizing high-pressure customer-impacting situations, reducing alert and incident noise, building playbooks, and driving long-term engineering corrections behind repeated escalations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- | | |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------|
| • Escalation Management | • Customer Communication |
| • Service Recovery | • Major Incident Handling |
| • Operational Excellence | • Executive Reporting |
| • RCA | • Global Support Leadership |

SELECTED IMPACT

- Reduced issue resolution time by 32%.
- Central authority for high-severity incidents.
- Authored 175+ playbooks in 5 months.
- Managed high-volume, 24x7 mission-critical support operations.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Escalations Manager / SRE Program Lead

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra / Allyis) | May 2021 - Present

- Serve as central escalation authority for high-severity incidents across Xbox support services and adjacent production platforms.
- Architected Azure SRE Agent platform for AI-driven incident diagnostics, triage, and remediation workflows across non-production and production environments.
- Designed automation integrating ICM, Application Insights, Log Analytics, Azure DevOps, Kusto, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, and Microsoft Teams notifications.
- Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% through alert rationalization, stale incident cleanup, playbook standardization, and automation-driven triage.

Azure Support Technical Lead

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Nov 2016 - May 2021

- Led a team of 15 engineers supporting Azure customer workloads, enterprise subscriptions, capacity questions, data migrations, and cross-team technical issues.
- Spearheaded Azure chat support initiatives and improved service responsiveness through process and tooling improvements.
- Managed Azure subscription and enterprise agreement scenarios, region capacity questions, identity concerns, and migration issues for customers and internal teams.
- Partnered with Microsoft product and engineering groups to escalate customer-impacting issues and advocate for product enhancements.

Operations Lead - Azure LiveSite Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | May 2012 - Nov 2016

- Led an operations organization spanning 12 senior engineers and 20 service engineers across Hyderabad and Redmond.
- Performed deep technical investigations into complex Azure production issues from cluster to blade level.
- Created PowerShell automation that saved thousands of manual hours annually across investigations, onboarding, and operational workflows.
- Drove Azure network monitoring, change management, incident handling, and large-scale service health investigations.

Systems Analyst / Support Engineer / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

- Built and decommissioned enterprise servers, configured clusters, patched systems, and supported production data center operations.
- Migrated large data volumes and installed packaged tools and applications across server environments.
- Supported foundational infrastructure engineering practices including hardware lifecycle, environment readiness, and deployment execution.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering - JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional: Implementing Microsoft Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals
- TechMahindra AI White Belt
- Google Introduction to Generative AI
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- TechM Curated AI for Beginners

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Role Keywords: Escalation Manager, staff escalation manager, customer escalation, service recovery, incident command, executive communication, cross-functional coordination, operational excellence

Cloud and Platform: Microsoft Azure, Azure App Service, Application Insights, Log Analytics, Azure Data Factory, Azure DevOps, Azure Key Vault, Azure Active Directory

Observability and Operations: Kusto Query Language, Power BI, LiveSite Operations, Incident Command, Root Cause Analysis, MTTR Reduction, Alert Rationalization, SLA/SLO/SLI

Automation and AI: PowerShell, Bicep, Infrastructure as Code, Logic Apps, CI/CD Pipelines, Generative AI, AI copilots, Agentic workflows, Multi-agent orchestration, Azure SRE Agent

Leadership: Executive communication, Customer and stakeholder management, Cross-functional program delivery, Escalation leadership, Technical mentoring, Global team leadership